NO. 27 アレルギーが増加する背景(1)

The past thirty to forty years have seen a huge increase in the number of children who suffer from allergies, and scientists are still looking for the explanation. Some have blamed increased air pollution, but it has also been found that allergies are common not only among children in the city but also among children in the countryside, where pollution is typically much lower.

A currently popular explanation for the rise in allergies is the so-called "*hygiene hypothesis." The basic idea is that young children brought up in an environment which is too clean are more at risk of developing allergies. Nowadays, people bathe and wash their clothes more frequently than in the past, and thanks to vacuum cleaners homes are less dusty, too. One result of all these changes is that in their early lives children are exposed to fewer *allergens - substances that can cause allergies - and this means that their bodies cannot build up natural immunity to them. Simply put, exposure to allergy-causing substances is necessary for natural protection against them to develop.

---

* hygiene「衛生」

* allergen「アレルゲン(アレルギーの原因となる物質)」

1	blame	他動詞・名詞	を非難する・のせいにする・責任・非難
2	accuse	他動詞	を訴える・を非難する
3	condemn	他動詞	を責める・に有罪の判決を出す
4	forgive	他動詞	(人・行為・罪など)を許す
5	apologize	自動詞	謝る
6	so-called	形容詞	いわゆる
7	hypothesis	名詞	仮説・(議論の)前提
8	premise	名詞	前提・[複数]建物の敷地
9	assume	他動詞	と思い込む・を引き受ける・を帯びる
10	risk	名詞・他動詞	危険(性)・を危険にさらす・あえて～する
11	dare	他動詞	あえて(大胆にも)～する
12	nowadays	副詞	この頃・最近では
13	bathe	自動詞・他動詞	入浴する・入浴させる
14	sink	自動詞・他動詞	沈む・(人・体が)崩れ落ちる・を鎮める
15	float	自動詞・他動詞	浮く・漂う・を浮かべる
16	drift	自動詞・名詞	漂う・(知らぬ間に)移り変わる・漂流物
17	dust	名詞	ほこり
18	substance	名詞	物質・本質・重要性

1	blame	
2	accuse	
3	condemn	
4	forgive	
5	apologize	
6	so-called	
7	hypothesis	
8	premise	
9	assume	
10	risk	
11	dare	
12	nowadays	
13	bathe	
14	sink	
15	float	
16	drift	
17	dust	
18	substance	